

Bhanu Cheepurupalli

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OBJECTIVE

Seeking to take up a Democratic Oversight Fellowship of up to twelve months with the U.S. House Committee on Oversight and Government Reform, drawing on research into congressional national-security oversight (Iran-Contra, the Boland Amendment) and current work tracking congressional oversight of frontier AI labs. The fellowship supports oversight investigations with the Committee's Democratic staff under Ranking Member Robert Garcia's leadership, the House's principal check on executive-branch power as government adopts AI, surveillance, and autonomous systems. The role is unpaid and, under House gift and ethics rules, cannot be self-funded, so an external living stipend, provided through an institutional host or a 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsor, is a precondition and must be secured by September 8, 2026. A budget outline is available on request.

EDUCATION

Claremont McKenna College Claremont, CA
Bachelor of Arts in International Relations and Philosophy Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- 2024 Harry S. Truman Scholarship Finalist; McKenna Achievement Scholar; Presidential Thesis Scholar; Class DEI Officer; Advocate for Survivors of Sexual Assault and Domestic Violence.

St. Anne's College, University of Oxford Oxford, UK
Visiting Student Programme in Politics Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

- Global Priorities Institute Scholar; Majlis Society Philanthropy Lead; Future Impact Group Residency; Oxford Union Society.

EXPERIENCE

U.S. House Committee on Oversight and Government Reform Washington, DC
Democratic Oversight Fellow *Incoming*

- Incoming fellow with the Committee's Democratic staff, the principal investigative authority of the House, supporting congressional oversight of the executive branch, including its adoption of AI and emerging technology.

AI Whistleblower Initiative Washington, DC
National Security Fellow Mar 2026 – Present

- Lead CORDA program research team building civic-transparency trackers of congressional oversight of frontier AI labs and national security, validating legislative behavior and public-record tracking into AIWI policy products.
- Analyze how Congress engages with whistleblowers, surveillance and autonomous-systems programs, and AI-enabled authoritarian threats; co-create national-security and AI-governance analyses with government partners.

EquiLabs New York, NY (Remote)
Fellowship Coordinator Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- Supported operations, site creation, and outreach for a UN-affiliated fellowship developing emerging youth leaders in digital rights and AI safety.

Mgrublian Center for Human Rights Claremont, CA
Program Assistant Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- Conducted human-rights archival research and source verification for Dr. Adam Jones's *Genocide: A Comprehensive Introduction*; led a 10-person research team under Professor Wendy Lower, training peers in human-rights and security data mapping.

UNICEF Evaluation Office New York, NY
Institutional Effectiveness Fellow May 2023 – Jan 2024

- Led roughly 55% of preparation for an organization-wide policy evaluation: drafted requests for proposals, ran the consultant-selection process, and aligned program outcomes to measurable performance indicators.
- Built a management-response dashboard tracking institutional accountability against SDG-aligned indicators, piloted across the office; hosted UNGA side-event dialogues and high-level programming on African humanitarian innovation.

Oxford Venture Capital Network Oxford, UK
Analyst Sep 2023 – Jan 2024

- Analyzed U.S. and U.K. construction-technology and climate-tech markets and advised founders on seed-extension round; won MT 2023 Best Pitch award for impact strategy for AI-driven construction-technology startup.

Luce Initiative on Asian Studies and the Environment Portland, ME
EnviroLab Asia Globalization Scholar Dec 2022 – Jun 2023

- Researched federal SBIR grant accessibility and wrote policy briefs on integrating climate technologies into Maine’s aquaculture sector, synthesizing technical and economic sources into written findings.

Oxfam Cambodia

Phnom Penh, Cambodia

Extractive Industries Fellow

Jun 2022 – Sep 2022

- Led a field investigation interviewing Indigenous leaders to document environmental and labor-rights violations in a critical-minerals negotiation, compiling accountability testimony that informed Free, Prior, and Informed Consent consultations. Led post-COVID financial-literacy and pension workshops for informal and gig-economy workers.

Amnesty International, Southern California

Claremont, CA

Chapter President

Sep 2021 – Jan 2024

- Created a youth-led “12 Hours of Action” criminal-justice campaign, on broken-windows policing, the 1033 program, and protest rights, that drew 800 global participants and won ActivismX Award. Presented at Amnesty International’s National Activism Conference on youth grassroots organizing and digital-era barriers to civic action.

RESEARCH

Keck Center for International and Strategic Studies

Claremont, CA

Research Analyst

Dec 2021 – Jun 2025

- Conducted archival analysis of congressional hearings on national-security and counter-narcotics legislation (Iran-Contra, the Boland Amendment), tracing executive strategy and the mechanics of congressional oversight.
- Conducted Passion Project Grant research on post-COVID-19 public policy for Asian-American communities.

Global Priorities Institute, University of Oxford

Oxford, UK

International Development Researcher

Sep 2023 – Jul 2024

- Ran quantitative analysis of state foreign-aid flows across ASEAN economies using IMF and World Bank data; produced cost-effectiveness analysis on biodiversity credits systems financing.

Soll Center for Student Opportunity, Claremont McKenna

Hong Kong SAR

Presidential Fund Researcher

Dec 2024 – Jun 2025

- Conducted field interviews with Hong Kong innovation-policy institutions (Science and Technology Parks Corporation, Cyberport, Asia Society) for a graduating thesis, “*Hong Kong’s Innovation System: Regulatory Applications in Deliberative Democracy*,” assessing advocacy literacy and efficacy in emerging-technology policy.

SELECTED WORKS

- Civic Transparency Report on congressional oversight of frontier labs (AI Whistleblower Initiative, CORDA).
- Forthcoming paper with Professor Michael Fortner on congressional oversight of executive national security.
- Contributing researcher on digital political violence for *Genocide: A Comprehensive Introduction* (Dr. Adam Jones).
- Co-author with Portfolio Chief Erica Mattellone, “Advocacy as a Change Strategy,” UNICEF Evaluation, Nov 2023.
- Author, “Evaluating Advocacy for Achieving Greater Impact for Children,” UNICEF Evaluation, Nov 2023.
- PEM III Evaluation Dissemination for the “People Protecting Ecosystems in the Mekong” natural resource governance and extractive industries campaign (Oxfam; MacArthur and Margaret A. Cargill Foundations).

SKILLS

Policy interests: AI governance, congressional and executive oversight, national security, technology policy, civil liberties

Research: legislative and archival research, OSINT, public-record verification, M&E, quantitative policy analysis

Technical: Python, GIS and remote sensing, data visualization, Salesforce, social media analytics, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace

Languages: Telugu (fluent), Hindi (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), Korean (basic), German (basic)

Certifications: UN Rights and Results-Based Management; UNICEF Programme Planning Process

REFERENCES

Karl Koch, Founder, AI Whistleblower Initiative

karl.koch@aiwi.org

Dr. John Pitney, Roy P. Crocker Professor of Politics, Claremont McKenna College

jpitney@cmc.edu

Erica Mattellone, Chief of Institutional Effectiveness, UNICEF Evaluation Office

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